

1st PEMNet National Extension Conference 2026

ABSTRACT TEMPLATE

Theme: **HEIs at the Forefront of Transformative Extension: Advancing Evidence-Based, Inclusive, Sustainable, and Resilient Community Development**

Instructions: Complete all sections. Select only one paper category and one thematic area. Use clear, evidence-based statements and avoid unsupported outcome or impact claims.

A. Paper Information

1. Title of the Extension Project Paper	BUILDING RESILIENCE THROUGH ENVIRONMENTAL EDUCATION FOR SUSTAINABILITY (BREES)
2. Author/s and Institutional Affiliation/s Note: Use an asterisk (*) after the name of the project leader. If the presenter is not the project leader, write "paper presenter" after the name	Lead Proponent/ Program Leader: Dr. Maria Wendy M. Solomo Members: Prof. Marina S. Villar Prof. Maribet C. Barrun Dr. Jocelyn P. Amata Dr. Maria Aurora G. Caballero Dr. Emy Lasarte Prof. Margarita M. Lanciso Institutional Affiliation: Partido State University, Goa, Camarines Sur
3. Name and Email Address of Corresponding Author	Dr. Maria Wendy M. Solomo solomo.mariawendy@parsu.edu.ph
3. Paper Category	☐ Completed Extension Project Paper ☒ Ongoing Extension Project Paper
4. Thematic Area (choose 1 only)	☐ Food Production, Agriculture, Fisheries, and Natural Resource Systems ☐ Health, Nutrition, Wellness, and Community Care ☐ Education, Literacy, Skills Development, and Lifelong Learning ☐ Livelihood, Entrepreneurship, Cooperatives, MSMEs, and Local Economic Development ☒ Environment, Climate Action, Disaster Risk Reduction, and Community Resilience

B. Extended Abstract Narrative

Guide: Write concise paragraphs under each required component.

5. Community or Sectoral Need Addressed

Briefly describe in not more than 150 words the validated community, institutional, or sectoral need addressed by the project.

Environmental education has been widely accepted as a means of promoting environmental literacy initiatives, which can serve as a solid basis for future environmental responsiveness and facilitate the shift toward more sustainable communities (Lloyd-Strovas et al., 2018; Shri &

Tiwari, 2021). In addition, to prevent further environmental degradation and the depletion of natural resources, UNESCO's Education for Sustainable Development (ESD) for the 2030 education initiative seeks to bring about social and personal transformation.

In order to address sustainability concerns, several scholarly works indicate that education for sustainable development and environmental education should be part of the curriculum at all levels (Sukma et al., 2020; Thathong, 2010; Enelund et al., 2015; Comhar, 2007; Venkataraman, 2009; Hopkins & McKeown, 2002).

The program "Building Resilience Through Environmental Education For Sustainability (BREES)" aims to inform the public about the latest environmental issues, motivating them to find solutions to the identified problems and adapt to environmental change.

6. Project Objectives

State the main objective/s of the extension project.

The program aimed to attain the following general objectives:

- Build resilient communities through environmental education and sustainable livelihood development.
- Promote environmental literacy among students, teachers, parents, and 4Ps beneficiaries to foster long-term environmental sustainability.

7. Extension Methods, Strategies, or Activities Implemented

Describe in not more than 300 words the major extension approaches, methods, strategies, or activities implemented.

The Extension Service conducted orientation and disseminated the program to the target clients. The orientation is intended to present the program and to determine the implementation procedures. Partido State University (PSU) and the Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD) entered into a memorandum of agreement (MOA) to formalize a partnership and document the commitment to sharing roles and resources.

The program: BUILDING RESILIENCE THROUGH ENVIRONMENTAL EDUCATION FOR SUSTAINABILITY (BREES) comprises five components. The first component, Green Tomorrow: Raising Awareness for a Sustainable Future, promotes environmental awareness and focuses on the current issues/challenges that the world and the country, particularly Camarines Sur, are experiencing. This will allow various sectors to discuss possible solutions, projects, and activities to address those issues.

Component 2, From Training to Earning: Sustainable Livelihood Starter Project, is designed to respond to the urgent need for practical, income-generating opportunities by transforming locally available resources into marketable products through skills-based training.

The third component, Act Now: Protecting Nature for Future Generation, will implement environmental initiatives, particularly tree planting and coastal cleanups. This component focuses on local initiatives or activities to conserve, restore, and improve environmental conditions.

Component 4, Sustainable Education for Environmental Development (SEED), is anchored on UNESCO's Education for Sustainable Development (ESD). Environmental literacy is integrated into the curriculum to encourage individuals to make informed, responsible choices that help create a more sustainable world. Educators will be capacitated on how to integrate sustainable development into curricula. The last component, Valuing Sustainable Environmental Education Initiatives, will recognize the efforts of various stakeholders in promoting environmental literacy to attain sustainable development.

8. Key Outputs, Emerging Results, and Evidence of Outcomes, Adoption, or Utilization

Briefly present in not more than 300 words the documented outputs and emerging results of the project. Include available evidence of outcomes, adoption, utilization, capability-building, institutional change, or public value, if applicable. Claims must be supported by verifiable evidence.

a. Major Outputs or Emerging Results

A. Training and Capacity Building: Educational and training sessions for students, teachers, and 4P's beneficiaries involved in environmental awareness campaigns and sustainable education. Capacity-building initiatives and Livelihood projects for 4P's beneficiaries to empower individuals with the knowledge and skills needed to advance environmental literacy and augment family incomes.

1. At least 75% of the participants (educators, local officials, 4 P's beneficiaries, and students) will report an enhancement in their environmental literacy as measured via Pre-test and Post-test Environmental Literacy Self-assessment Tools and focus-group discussions.

2. At least 50% increase in the 4P's beneficiaries' family income through the livelihood projects.

3. At least 60% of the locals will adopt environmental initiatives/activities and report an improvement in their environmental practices measured through survey questionnaires and interviews.

4. At least 75% of the teachers will report an enhancement in the 4P's students' environmental literacy by integrating environmental sustainability in their lessons, measured via Pre and Post Survey Questionnaires on environmental sustainability and developed learning resources.

B. Community Engagement Initiatives: Environmental initiatives/activities such as tree-planting activities, coastal cleanups, environmental restoration, and conservation.

C. Environmental Advocates. Establishment of GREEN Force (Global Restoration & Environmental Empowerment Network) with at least 20 members who are environmental advocates

D. Activities and collaborative efforts. Activities that promote community ownership and involvement in resolving local environmental issues.

E. Educational Materials: Printed modules, brochures, interactive and digital resources on environmental sustainability.

b. Evidence of Outcomes, Adoption, or Utilization

[Type response here. If not yet available, write: "Not yet available."]

Not yet available

c. Supporting Documents/Evidence Available

[Examples: attendance sheets, monitoring reports, photos, testimonials, adoption records, partnership agreements, policy issuances, utilization reports, or other proof.]

1. Pre and Post Environmental Literacy Self-assessment Tools assessing environmental knowledge and environmental attitudes and values before and after the implementation of the project.

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2. Attendance Record to monitor the participation of the beneficiaries. Moreover, Video and Photo Documentation with Narrative Reports to capture the salient activities of the project.
3. Learning and training module outputs, and group outputs for livelihood trainings
4. Focus Group Discussions (FGDs) Minutes - Various FGDs will be conducted with various sectors. Recorded and transcribed qualitative data will be gathered to capture personal insights and perceived impact.
5. Self-Assessment Tool on Environmental Practices will be conducted before and after the project implementation to measure the environmental initiatives and practices.
6. Environmental Education Integration is reflected in their Daily Lesson Log (DLL). The degree of integration could be assessed in the Instructional Materials and Learning Resources designed by the teachers.

9. Sustainability Direction or Next Steps

Explain in not more than 150 words how the project will be sustained, institutionalized, scaled, or improved, or state the next steps for ongoing projects.

The Building Resilience through Environmental Education for Sustainability (BREES) Program shall pursue a sustainability direction anchored on the continuous integration of environmental education, community participation, sustainable livelihood development, and resilience-building practices. The program shall move beyond short-term environmental activities by establishing mechanisms that enable students, teachers, parents, and 4Ps beneficiaries to sustain environmentally responsible practices and translate acquired knowledge and skills into concrete actions within their homes, schools, workplaces, and communities.

The sustainability of BREES shall be strengthened through the institutionalization of environmental education and capacity-building activities, the development of community-based environmental initiatives, and the promotion of sustainable livelihood opportunities that are compatible with environmental protection. These initiatives shall be supported through continuous mentoring, skills enhancement, resource mobilization, and partnerships with local government units, schools, community organizations, government agencies, and other stakeholders.

C. Keywords

10. Keywords, three to five keywords: [Environmental Education; Resilience; Sustainability; Livelihood; Environmental Literacy]

For PEMNet Abstract Review Committee Use Only:

- ☐ Recommended for Acceptance
☐ Not Recommended for Acceptance

Reviewed by: _____
Chair, PEMNet Scientific / Abstract Review Committee